

After heating and cooling, dehumidifiers are one of the biggest electricity and energy hogs.⁶

Make it a habit to unplug your kitchen appliances when not in use, and put away your chargers when you don't need them. If you have a bunch of cords in the same general area, grab a surge protector that you can easily switch on and off.

It does take some getting used to, but every little bit helps. It's kind of funny, but I always know I've gone on an electricity saving binge when my bagel never toasts the first time around. I always forget to plug the toaster oven back in!

4. CONSERVE LIGHT USAGE

While it seems like a no-brainer to turn lights off when you leave the room, we have all been guilty of forgetting to do this at some point. A simple flick of the switch is all it takes, and you should do this even if you're leaving the room for only a few minutes. Also, table or floor lamps use a lot less energy than overhead lights do, so if you're sitting in a corner reading or watching TV, opt for a smaller lamp to light up the room.

Another option is to switch out all incandescent bulbs after they burn out with CFL bulbs. These work at partial capacity, which means they use 75% less energy, and last ten times longer than normal bulbs. Even though CFL's are more expensive than incandescent bulbs, their long life span makes the switch more than worth it. However, since these bulbs contain mercury, you want to be super careful when disposing of them.

Here's what to do when a CFL bulb breaks⁷:

- Have family and pets leave the room, then air out for about ten to fifteen minutes.
- Shut off the heating or cooling system.